

Research Paper: Meaning of Life in Old Testament

OT-5111: Old Testament

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Introductory Paragraph

This paper is about the meaning of life and how it relates to the beginning of the old testament. The meaning of life is one of the most important questions in life and the Bible, especially the Old Testament is about life. How life began in genesis is an indication of what the meaning of life is. The various trials and stories of various people in the Old Testament tell us more about our own lives and about the meaning of life. I will relate the stories in the Old Testament to the questions that are related to the meaning of life. The sources used as references are usually psychological studies that show that religion, and also Christianity needs to improve feelings of meaning of life and happiness. one of the gifts that God wants to give us is meaning of life. with a meaning for our lives, we are able to do more.

Charles Swindoll was the author that was recommended to me by Faith bookstore in Guam. There was one story in there that stood out the most to me and will stick with me for the rest of my life. It was about Hope and the meaning of life. Charles said that there was a Vietnam POW, who is in jail for years and years however, he always had this hope that one day he would be saved. finally that hope was crushed by a letter that said that he would never be released. He died the same day he heard that news. The reason he died was because he lacked hope and meaning of life when he lack hope and meaning of life, there is no reason to live, and there is no power. Rick Warren says in his book, a person without meaning of life has no motivation to overcome even the smallest difficulties. Can be seen in the many studies that are referenced in the bibliography and this paper religion increases the meaning of life. Therefore, there is all the more reason to have religion in our lives. More importantly as a Christian, I want to show that Genesis and Exodus and all the books of the Old Testament show us that the meaning of life is important. For example, the hope for us

to enter into the promised land and into the rest, gives a strength and meaning of life and endure the wilderness of our lives. All of the stories of the Bible will help us establish a stronger meaning of life. The Old Testament tells us the meaning of life through stories of overcoming difficulties, miracles, God's provision, God's character, God's love, and God's relationship with man.

According to source number one¹, as adolescent Czech students who are more spiritual, and are more church affiliated have more meaning of life and happiness. This shows the intrinsic character of human beings. This study is not showing some characteristics of Czech adolescence that are not in congruence with other people. The purpose of psychological studies is to show that there are characteristics intrinsic to human beings into their psychology that are built in by God it is clear from the moment that God breathed life into Adam and Eve, that the psychology of man was created so that they would have spirituality and meaning of life. From the study, we can see that church attendance is correlated with increased happiness and meaning of life. This is in congruence with the fact that God created Adam

¹Kosarkova, Alice, and Marcela Fojtikova Roubalova. 2024. "I Am Young, Religious and/or Spiritual--Is It Beneficial to Me?: Association of Religiosity, Spirituality and Images of God with Meaning in Life and Self-Esteem in Adolescents." *Religions* 15 (1): 1–14. doi:10.3390/rel15010017.

and Eve in Genesis. God said that man must not be alone that it is not good for man to be alone. Therefore, when we look at psychological studies that are experimental and look from the outside, and we can see that God's nature and God in the Old Testament and God and Genesis is written on the heart and mind of man. When we discover our meaning of life, the Czech adolescents will be able to be able to live life a little bit more happier, and we will all be able to be more motivated to face life's challenges and live a better life.

According to source number two², we find that spirituality is the key factor that improves general meaning of life and higher meaning of life. We also find that religion alone does not affect meaning of life as religion is just an institution and ritual and can be the void of spirituality. the study was done in Slovenia. There's a discussion about general meaning of life and higher meaning of life. I do not want this discussion to be focused on that however, just a small aside is that higher meaning of life is more important than general meaning of life a general meaning of life maybe I know what to do day-to-day basis and just take care of my family and just get by on a day-to-day basis, but higher meaning of life is a higher purpose and

² Kržan, Matija. 2023. "Life's Meaning and Religion in Contemporary Europe: The Case of Slovenia." *Fieldwork in Religion* 18 (1): 53–87. doi:10.1558/firn.24304.

spiritual. according to the study general meaning of life is not what leads to happiness. it is the higher meaning of life, which is spiritual that leads to happiness. God created us higher than the animals. When God created us. He said that it was good that the animals recreated, but he said it was very good when he created us. there is something higher about us. There is something divine about us something higher than the animals. we are created in the image of God no other animals is created in the image of God. and to be created in the image of God, it is not just to have some human physical form that looks like God, but it also includes God's heart mind God soul God's feeling God's thoughts. We are part takers of the nature of God. And in the study, we find that just wrote religion and sacrifices do not promote meaning of life and spirituality. This is found all across the Old Testament, for example an exodus where they are in the wilderness. They do all sorts of sacrifices all sorts of things, but it does not promote spirituality. Also all throughout the Old Testament. We find examples Who do sacrifices and all sorts of burnt offerings like the kings of Israel never satisfied God or inner desire for God.

Covid was one of the most difficult situations in all of our lives. It was a time when we were stuck at our homes without much social interaction and we

were in fear and some of us were dying. There is a research study³ that shows that in Turkey attitudes led to higher meaning of life which led to less depression, once again, it is clear that the psychological studies are pointing that having a higher spirituality leads to higher meaning of life which leads to happiness. as a pastor and future minister, I want to promote happiness not a religion, but happiness is something that we all seek and the solution to all things. Makarios is the Greek word for blessing. It simply means happiness. Salvation is a general word in the Old Testament that means happiness in my opinion whenever someone is blessed in the Old Testament, it is very clear. It means that they have children. They have a large family. They have a lot of animals and they are very happy. This is the blessing of God and God wants us to be happy to be happy we need to also understanding of suffering. All throughout Genesis and exodus there is a lot of times of suffering and waiting upon the Lord. The way to overcome such stresses and difficulties is to have a strong spirituality and meaning of life. Meaning of life is very clearly related to hope, and God promised, and made a covenant with us and said that we would enter into the promised land and gave us a hope. This hope, and this faith overcomes the world. During Covid, the non-Christians were

³ Koçak, Orhan. 2022. "How Religious Attitudes Are Associated with Depression in Turkish Society during the COVID-19 Pandemic: The Mediating Role of Meaning in Life." Religions 13 (10): 1–21. doi:10.3390/rel13100956.

wearing. Am I gonna die? Am I gonna get Covid? You know what's gonna happen to the world am I gonna go to heaven? But the Christians were steadfast they hoped in the Lord and they ran even when others grew weary. so as a pastor, I say, hoping the Lord have your meaning in Christ and you will overcome all things in this world and you'll find happiness and purpose.

According to source number four⁴, religious commitment led to meaning of life and happiness however, the search for meaning did not lead to meaning of life or happiness. This study was done on Ghana university students. This shows the predicament of university students. They are still young in their lives and they are searching for the meaning of life and the people who hold fast to religious commitment. Find that meaning of life and are able to do well in school, it is true that the Bible says it is good for a young man to be trained in the Lord, I believe it is a blessed thing to believe in the Lord and to find the meaning of life early in life. The study also says that the search for the meaning of life does not lead to happiness, but actually finding it does all sorts of non-Christians are always searching for

⁴ Wilson, Angelina, Itumeleng P Khumalo, and Elias Mpofu. 2022. "Meaning in Life Among Ghanaian University Students: Does Religious Commitment Matter?" *Journal of Religion and Health* 61 (3): 2482–99. doi:10.1007/s10943-021-01405-4.

the meaning of life that's called being lost according to Christianity. when you're searching for the meaning of life, it means that you have not found it and you are lost it like the Old Testament stories where people have forsaken and have gone off after the prostitute and are doing all sorts of evil things and they don't know why God is so far away and why God is not answering their prayers. When God's prophets come, they want to kill God's prophets. But the few who repent the remnant they find life.

According to the source number five⁵, we see that the original theistic philosophers believe that man's meaning is given by the fulfillment of God's purposes, this is divine purpose theory however money atheist are attacking this in every fashion, saying that we can be meaningful apart from God, I believe our lives have meaning because of God. It is the greatest attempt of Satan to tell us to not follow God and not to believe in him follow the Bible. This is exactly what the atheistic philosopher are promoting. We need to find our purpose and meaning of life in the Bible and God. in exodus God gave the 10 Commandments he said thou shall not make false idols. He was telling us what to do and when we do what he tells us to do we find meaning and purpose. As Rick Warren says because he created

⁵ Koons, Jeremy Randel2022 .. "God's Goodness, Divine Purpose, and the Meaning of Life: Meet the New Euthyphro Dilemma." *European Journal for Philosophy of Religion* 14 (2): 229–46. doi:10.24204/ejpr.2022.3410.

us, he knows how we are supposed to operate. When he buy an electronic device, there is a users manual and the creator of the device and tell us how to use the device. We are also an electronic device type of device except we are a human being. We have a user manual, which is the Bible. We need to follow the Bible in order to find meaning of life and find out how to live our lives correctly. Life is directly related to how I should live my life in certain situations, especially when it gets difficult. And the Bible is filled with stories of difficulties and Christians overcoming difficulties.

The meaning of life is fraught with difficulties. One of the questions I always ask is what is the meaning of life? Is there a meaning of life and what is it? It's more like an existential question where I'm facing difficulties and I just don't see a way out and why I'm alive. This is why I wrote my paper on the meaning of life because I have a real situation where I can ask this question about the meaning of life every day. when life gets difficult I ask what is the meaning of life. The only thing that keeps me going is the Bible. It is the fellowship with my family - the love that I feel in my relationships. And the kindness I feel from different things. This is not a religion not some formula. This is the truth. This is life. This is real. Christianity is not something that goes from the outside and it really is the

ultimate truth that is from the very inside out. throughout the old testament we've always been seeking for that Christ. We've been seeking for that Messiah, who would redeem us from all of our sins and hardship, and when we finally found the Christ, we said hosanna in the highest. But we find that we must want the same path as Christ and take up our cross, but what I found is that this is Joy. That we should count it all joy. As we can see in the Psalms, David cries out to God, so many times. We see in the historical books of the Old Testament, we see that the Christians make all sorts of mistakes. And someone in the midst of the confusion and difficulties we can find comfort because we have fellowship with one another. We are also on our journey to enter into the promised land, which is heaven.

In conclusion, the meaning of life is very difficult. I'm almost certain that no one has figured it out perfectly. But at the same time, it is very simple. The reason why I say it's difficult it's because we always wonder when will I get to heaven and when will this all difficulties end but the reason why I see it is because Jesus is the solution to all of these questions, but the reason why it's difficult is because even though we know the answer, we don't feel it completely and we don't receive the full force of heaven as of right now we

still see the weight of sin and the body of death that is chained to us.

Therefore, the psychological studies show that we need to go back to the garden of Eden and we need to go back to God in the 10 Commandments and we need to go back to correct sacrifices and correct living and living according to the 633 Commandments of God in order to please God and have a meaning of life in accordance with God law. We need to not just believe in Jesus, but also live in accordance to his Law. Then we will find life and the meaning of life.

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